Component pass · q-and-a

The Q&A slide, on one baseline

Six looks, four measured misalignments, and a spine that stopped dangling

Anticipated questions

What the board will press on.

01 **Why commit the full amount now rather than staging it across two fiscal years?**

The discount lapses in Q3.

02 **What happens if the pilot misses its adoption target?**

We hold the second tranche.

03 **Who owns the outcome?**

One executive, reporting monthly.

— The index was an absolute mark at `top: 0`, which lands its box on the question's box, not its baseline. It is a flex item now, so the two share a baseline exactly.

The spine no longer overshoots its nodes.

Why does a rail need a fix at all?

It spanned the canvas; the nodes sat centered in it.

How far did it dangle?

62px above the first node, 122px below the last.

What draws it now?

Each pair draws its own segment, centre to centre.

— A per-pair segment cannot dangle: its length is the pair's own height plus the one gap below it, and both are known where it is drawn.

The exhibit row reads as one line again.

01	**What was misaligned?**	The answer sat 7.9px high.
02	**Why did that happen?**	The row aligned boxes, not baselines.
03	**And the numeral?**	It reads 01 now, like every other look.

— Three type sizes aligned by box top will never share a line. `align-items: baseline` is the only setting that does what an exhibit table promises.

A pair now looks like a pair.

How much air sat inside a pair?

Thirty-one pixels.

And between two pairs?

Thirty-four — so nothing grouped.

— Proximity is the only thing telling a reader where one pair ends. A ratio of 1.1 was not doing it; the tightened pair and opened gap read 2.6, at no cost in capacity.

The quadrant tops align at any length.

01

Why did the old reserve fail?

A three-line question blew straight through it.

02

What did it cost when it worked?

Forty-two pixels of dead air per cell.

03

Where is the numeral?

Over its own question, not in a gutter.

04

What aligns now?

Every question top, at every length.

— The two-line reserve bought answer alignment in the easy case and lost it in the hard one. Top-packing aligns the questions exactly, always, and spends nothing.

One question, at its own scale.

01 Why was the numeral the wrong size here?

The stage re-declared the token and won.

— The private tokens moved off `> .cell-stage` onto the section, so a modifier and the default now sit in the same cascade and specificity decides. This line had been inert since it was written.

Summary

What this pass changed.

Numeral and question share a baseline in every look — measured 0px, from the rendered PNG

The spine's rail begins and ends on a node

`rail` aligns its three columns; `grid` aligns its four question tops

`tab` groups its pairs at no cost in capacity